tell something troubled him. “What’s wrong?”

“I feel guilty leaving my patients on their own.”

“There’s nothing more you can do for them. We’re out of medicine. There’s hardly any electricity. If you’re here or not, it doesn’t matter.”

“It still feels like I’m abandoning them.”

“You’ve sacrificed all your time to look after them, saving so many lives. Now, it’s time to take care of yourself.”

He tapped her on the nose. “You and Katya are who I want to look after now.”

“Are you upset we’re not going to Prague?”

“We can’t go with the Soviet army there. I promise one day to bring you and Katya to my magnificent city.” She loved how he’d readily accepted Katya into their lives and never questioned the promise she’d made to Nadiya. He turned to face her. “Do you think I’ll be able to get a medical license in France?” He took a beat. “It almost seems like a dream, too good to be true.”

“To live in France?”

“To live with you and practice medicine. It’s all—”

A truck rumbled outside. They listened. For the last days, German troops had been moving through Glashütte, making their way south to the border. Then the quiet returned.

“Everyone is getting out before the Russians come.” He looked at her, his eyes reflecting the uncertainty of what would happen tomorrow. “We’re doing the right thing, aren’t we?”

“Do we have a choice? The German women are frightened about what will happen when the soldiers arrive. They’ve been told they’re animals who want vengeance. We can’t risk staying.”

“Come here,” he said, pulling her close. “How did we find one another in the middle of a war?”

“I want to tell you something.”

“Yes?”

“I’ve never been with a man before.”

“And?”

Why was this so hard to say when every part of her body longed for him? Her heart had been shut, he’d opened it, and now she wanted him to open it more. “I’d like you to be the first.”